



RED BANNER ALERT

mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident	12 December 2023	Time of Incident	0800
Directorate / Region	RMO – Wheatbelt	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Near Miss/ Injury	EQSafe Incident Number	36179
Actual Consequence	Insignificant	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Traffic Controller sitting on roadway
-----------------------------------	---------------------------------------

What Happened

At approximately 0800 on Tuesday 12 December, a Main Roads representative has observed a Traffic Controller (TC) sitting on the fog line of the southbound lane of Northam-Pithara Road.

The TC had been tasked with replacing the two wheels of a mobile light unit to prepare to demobilise the unit from site. To replace the tyre on the right side of the trailer, the TC sat within the live lane, with their back to the oncoming traffic. The posted speed where the TC was sitting was 60km/hr.

While the TC was located on the fog line, three vehicles (two members of public and one Main Roads representative) travelled through the site after being released from the PTC, which was being operated by another TC. The TC operating the PTC was unaware that the other TC was sitting on the road replacing the tyre.



Re-enactment of the incident

The Main Roads representative immediately pulled off to the work area to address the TC and call away from the roads edge. Works were immediately ceased, and the TC was removed from site indefinitely.

A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to
Interaction With Live Traffic

**Distribution of
Notice**

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations